Poem

I Dream of Spices



My mother would say:
"Little boy Raj...
Go to Muthu's
and get some
cinnamon, betel leaves
and ginger and garlic."



And so I go to the shops
singing all the way
and when Muthu asks me
what I'd want
I rattle off a list:
"Sesame seeds, onions
tomatoes and pickles"



And back home,
Mother twists my ears
Ouch!

Raj Arumugam



GLOSSARY

cinnamon	-	the bark of a tree that gives a delicious flavour to food
garlic	-	a small bulb with a strong taste used in cooking
rattle off	-	recite
sesame seeds	-	gingelly seeds
ouch	-	sound that expresses pain